

5.9.4 Closing the shoulder

New

Shoulders are not generally used as traffic lanes; however, shoulders may be used by cyclists and, in some cases, by motorcyclists. Parking lanes may also appear to some road users as possible traffic lanes.

Where works require the closure of the area outside of the traffic lane (shoulder), to ensure road users do not inadvertently traverse the area behind the delineation of works, the following options apply:

1. Where the shoulder may be used by cyclists and, in some cases, motorcyclists, a short taper at a 45 degree angle to traffic should be provided (see Figures 5.9.4(a), 5.9.4(b) and 5.9.4(c)). This is the preferred method of closing a shoulder.
2. Where the shoulder is unlikely to be used by other road users, subject to a risk assessment, a square closure may be implemented (see Figures 5.9.4(d) and 5.9.4(e)).
3. Where there is a very wide shoulder (for example, wide road reserves in rural towns or where angle parking is provided), subject to a risk assessment, a combination of these options may be implemented (see Figure 5.9.4(f)).

Devices which may be used to close the shoulder include traffic cones, bollards, Temporary Hazard markers, barrier boards, or a combination of these, depending on the site characteristics. The following Figures do not include all traffic control devices required and are not to be used as TGS diagrams.

Figure 5.9.4(a) – Closing a shoulder at a 45 degree angle

